The Jungle Newsroom

Best of the week

what carried on growing

THINGS WE SAW

- John Lewis's ad is still the week's big talking point
- KFC's Doom menu and the Hunger Games stunt: two film tie-ins
- Arsenal's Christmas film stars Colin Firth
- Barbour's Christmas short brings back Wallace and Gromit
- Boots' Christmas ad goes to TV
- GTA 6 has an estimated 7.71 million pre-orders

PLATFORM HIGHLIGHTS

- Instagram's Edits comes to Mac
- Meta's Muse AI can now talk, US first

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Peaking UK TV & X

The John Lewis ad is still the week's big debate

System1 says the ad scores 5.6 stars, its best John Lewis result since 2019, with 69% reacting positively and 6% showing contempt. That is System1's own research, shared by its Chief Growth Officer in The Drum. Metro's columnist says the culture-war backlash is louder than the numbers.

> **Why it matters:** It started the week as a pile-on. The testing says most viewers liked it.

The Drum, 4 Nov; Metro, 4 Nov · Image: John Lewis via Metro
thedrum.com/opinion/andrew-tindall-they-may-be-loud-but-on...



Rising | UK | Brand launch

Two film tie-ins: KFC's Doom menu and a Hunger Games TV stunt

KFC's Doctor Doom menu, with a black sesame bun burger, reaches UK and Ireland restaurants on 9 Nov, ahead of Avengers: Doomsday. Eastern Eye gives the film's UK date as 16 Dec. Earlier this week viewers also saw an in-universe Hunger Games clip in US election coverage, per indy100. Sunrise on the Reaping opens on 20 Nov, per listings.

> **Why it matters:** Two ways to sell a film: a menu and a stunt in a moment everyone watches.

Eastern Eye, 5 Nov; Decision Marketing, 4 Nov; indy100, 4 Nov · Image: KFC via Eastern Eye
easterneye.biz/kfc-doctor-doom-uk-meal

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Rising | UK | YouTube & social

Colin Firth stars in Arsenal's Christmas film

Arsenal's Christmas film, "'Twas the Season", has Colin Firth as a fan walking through Islington crowds, with Alessia Russo, Riccardo Calafiori and Gabriel Magalhães. Metro says Firth's Portuguese exchange with the players nods to Love Actually. The tagline is "Gifts worth waiting all season for".

> **Why it matters:** A football club making a proper Christmas ad. The cast does the work.

Metro, 5 Nov · Image: Arsenal via Metro
metro.co.uk/2026/11/05/colin-firth-makes-love-actually-nod...



Rising | UK | YouTube

Wallace and Gromit star in Barbour's Christmas short

Barbour's new 90-second Christmas short with Wallace and Gromit, made with Aardman, has Gromit rescuing Wallace's Walk-o-Matic test. A mischievous sheep also appears. A Metro writer calls it his favourite ad so far, though a colleague prefers another.

> **Why it matters:** Familiar characters, a clear story and a very British feel. Opinion is split on the best ad.

Metro, 5 Nov · Image: Barbour via Metro
metro.co.uk/2026/11/05/forget-muppets-wallace-gromit-best-...



Rising | UK | TV & YouTube

Boots takes its Christmas campaign to TV

Boots' campaign, "For Gifts They'll Really Love", went online on 4 Nov and goes to TV on 6 Nov, under its new "Give it Some Boots" platform. It is a 60-second film, with the brand's first 20-second edits. Retail Gazette says the TV roadblock aims to reach six million people over launch weekend.

> **Why it matters:** A big TV launch weekend. The first 20-second edits are the detail to note.

Retail Gazette, 4 Nov · Image: Boots via Retail Gazette
retailgazette.co.uk/blog/2026/11/watch-boots-christmas

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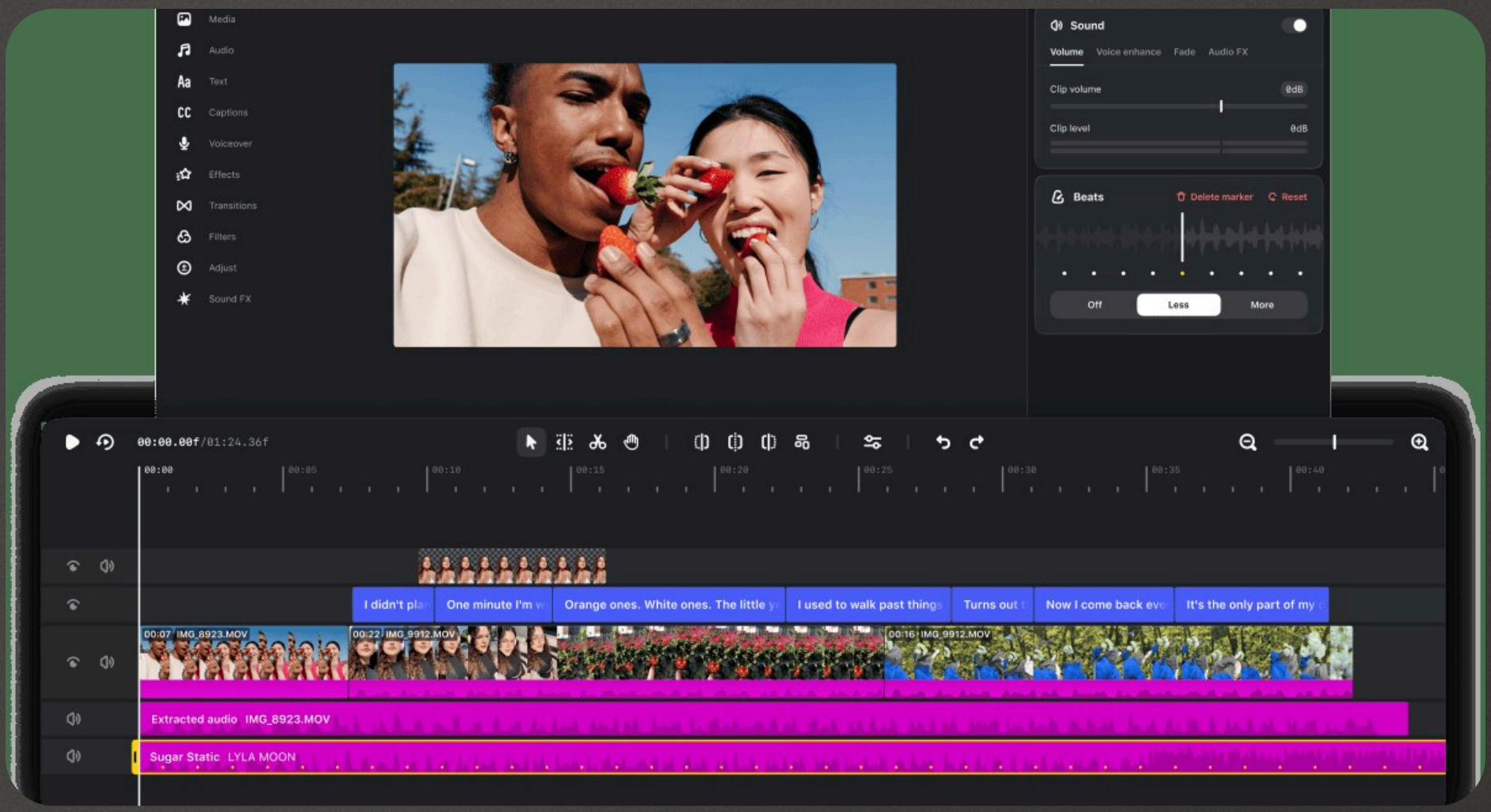
Rising | Global | X & YouTube

GTA 6 has an estimated 7.71 million pre-orders

Sensor Tower estimates 7.71 million pre-orders for GTA 6, worth about $751 million, ahead of its 19 Nov launch. GamesIndustry.biz and Metro both report the figure. It is Sensor Tower's estimate of digital pre-orders, not a Take-Two number.

> **Why it matters:** Two weeks out, a game is already a cultural event. Expect it to fill feeds from 19 Nov.

Metro, 5 Nov; GamesIndustry.biz, 5 Nov · Image: Rockstar via Metro
metro.co.uk/2026/11/05/gta-6-isnt-even-yet-already-sold-ei...



Rising | Global | Instagram

Instagram's Edits video editor comes to Mac

Edits now has a Mac app, launched on 5 Nov. Social Media Today and TechCrunch say it has a multi-track timeline, 4K watermark-free export and syncs with the mobile app. UK availability isn't stated.

> **Why it matters:** Easier editing on a laptop for anyone making Reels.

Social Media Today, 5 Nov; TechCrunch, 5 Nov · Image: Instagram via TechCrunch
socialmediatoday.com/news/edits-launches-for-macos/873949

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Rising | Global | Meta

Meta's Muse AI can now talk, US first

Meta says its Muse AI assistant now has voice and expressive avatars, with hundreds of voices to choose from. It is rolling out in the US first, so it isn't in the UK yet. Meta says voice is coming soon to its AI glasses.

> **Why it matters:** A signal of where Meta's AI is going. Nothing to use in the UK yet.

Meta, 5 Nov; Social Media Today, 5 Nov · Image: Meta
about.fb.com/news/2026/11/introducing-muse-ai-voice-expres...

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Things to watch this week

Fri 6 Nov

M&S Christmas ad due

Teased this week with James Norton. Unconfirmed until M&S posts it.

Sat 7 Nov

Strictly Come Dancing

A live Saturday show. Jaime Winstone is out this week. Check the BBC listing for the time.

Mon 9 Nov

KFC Doom menu starts

UK and Ireland launch of the Marvel tie-in.

Thu 19 Nov

GTA 6 launches

Expect feed takeovers around launch.

Fri 20 Nov

Hunger Games opens

Sunrise on the Reaping UK date per listings. Confirm with the cinemas.

For Disney UK

Pip · Disney UK desk

IDEA · FILM TIE-INS

A Hexed 27 Nov countdown that uses one bold, simple visual each day.

Approved assets only. Cinema date Fri 27 Nov.

IDEA · CHRISTMAS ADS

A short “get the family to the cinema” teaser for Hexed.

No ratings or reviews claims.

WATCH OUT

Hexed’s UK rating and assets need sign-off first. No other release dates go out.

For Disney Family UK

Bo · Disney Family UK desk

IDEA · CHRISTMAS ADS

A “which Christmas ad is your family’s favourite?” poll.

Don’t name brands we don’t work with.

IDEA · STRICTLY SATURDAY

A family sofa-night Saturday post.

No spoilers about the show.

WATCH OUT

Keep any Christmas content clear of other brands’ ads.

For Disney Store UK

Lulu · Disney Store UK desk

IDEA · WALLACE AND GROMIT

A cosy winter-gifting post that borrows the “inventor’s gift” idea.

Use only products in stock. No copying the ad.

IDEA · CHRISTMAS ADS

An advent-style “first Christmas gifts” gift guide.

Prices and stock must be checked.

WATCH OUT

No Marvel or Hexed content without licensing sign-off.

For Mutti UK

Kiki · Mutti UK desk

IDEA · FRIDAY NIGHT IN

A sofa-night snack post: tomato toasties for a Friday night in.

Recipe must be tested and approved by Mutti.

IDEA · BOOTS TV LAUNCH

A quick “festive pasta” recipe for the launch weekend.

Recipe must be approved by Mutti.

WATCH OUT

Don’t reference other brands’ ads or shortages by name.

For Optimum Nutrition UK

Rex · Optimum Nutrition UK desk

IDEA · GTA 6

A “game night fuel” post: quick protein snacks.

Don’t use any game imagery or title in the artwork.

IDEA · WEEKEND

A short “gym before the weekend” workout.

Keep health claims within approved wording.

WATCH OUT

No health or performance claims beyond the approved list.

For DFS

Dot · DFS desk

IDEA · CHRISTMAS ADS

A “cosy Christmas sofa” post with throws and cushions.

Use approved product shots.

IDEA · STRICTLY SATURDAY

A “best seat in the house” sofa shot for Saturday night TV.

No tagging the show or BBC.

WATCH OUT

Any sale or price wording needs approval first.

Did we miss something?

Spotted something we missed? Or want more of something tomorrow? Reply under this post in #agency-hq.

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